
Memorandum

THE ARLINGTON INSTITUTE [REDACTED]

To: Steve Greer
From: John L. Petersen
Date: 3 December 1993
Subject: Security

I talked to Woolsey this morning and he suggested getting together over dinner. He was not aware of your organization or that anyone was planning such an announcement. He seemed genuinely surprised. This almost certainly means that, 1) there is an active attempt being made at lower levels of government to sabotage Project Starlight, 2) this group almost certainly has tapped your phones and is aware of most of the details of your plans, 3) they are feeding information gathered from their collection (like the fact that you might be meeting with Woolsey) back to you in a negative way, and, 3) there is no Aquarian Group.

Up until now, you have been an interesting operation that these folks in the government have been keeping an eye on, etc. If we do have the dinner with Jim, we will have moved this whole thing to a much, much higher plane and in doing so raised significant red flags for those who don't want to see this succeed. Operation Starlight will become a serious threat to the status quo. In the same way that you wouldn't volunteer all of your most detailed plans to one of the most inflammatory members of the UFO "ghetto," knowing that he or she would use it to work against your ends, so you must not volunteer sensitive information to others who would have similar objectives.

Meetings with people like Woolsey must be kept very closely guarded. I have not even told Diane about it. I just told her that we were having some people over for dinner on the 14th. There is no good reason to tell others about these things unless they have a "need to know," particularly because in doing so you alert the opposition. In this case, Jim will almost certainly have someone check you and your organization out before our dinner. If the opposition knows what is going on, they can obviously influence that report (perhaps so much so that Woolsey cancels.) We must not let that happen.

Woolsey and other national leaders like him have huge stakes at risk in meeting with people like you. In addition to personal reputations, etc., they represent our country at the highest levels and have a responsibility for the wellbeing (such as it is) of the society. Their every move is projected, writ large, on the giant screen of public opinion and is always vulnerable to the indefatigable scrutiny and prying of the press. They must be very careful when they get "out of the box." Remember the story you told me about the reaction by Pell to the suggestion of a new approach in foreign relations. Remember my characterization: They are not risk-takers. Just think of what it would do to our ability to deal with him in the future if, like the Rockefeller meeting, it became known in the leadership of the "ghetto" that we were talking to him. That would get back to him and we would never have access to him or anyone else of substance in the government again.

I know that you are not used to these kinds of things, but you are at the place where you must start thinking like a statesman rather than the director of a nonprofit organization in North Carolina. You must understand that great principalities and powers will oppose your plans -- if they know about them. I am not suggesting a major lifestyle shift, but just common prudence. Stop and think before telling someone about a sensitive aspect of the project if it is important that the person know, and if they tell someone else, what might the effect be. This is an extremely important project that we are pursuing. We must begin to act like it is as important (and explosive) as it is.

Although you have a wonderful understanding of what this all means in the end, and how important it is, with absolutely enormous respect for you let me suggest that you may not yet have a very good grasp of the magnitude and hazards of the mid-term process that starts to get us to the objective. I have often thought of the government and our society like a human body. You can scuff it and abrade it and it doesn't respond seriously. But the moment you

If we can insert this thing quickly enough at a high enough level, a good deal of the risk will be eliminated. But in any case, those who would like to scuttle the project and have the means to monitor it will continue to pass information to other groups outside of government (arch-conservatives, fundamentalist religious groups, etc.) who will always be a problem. We will win at this if we are smart about how we do it. We will not if we are not.

Remember: the most powerful people in the world will have a deep, compelling interest in our activities and will use *everything* at their disposal to effect their objectives.

I am having a security plan drawn up by a friend and should have something for you soon. In the mean time, if the portable phone in your kitchen does not have an encryption function on it you should not use it to talk about CSETI affairs. Any kid with a scanner within a one mile radius of your home can monitor those calls. We should not be broadcasting this stuff.

I do believe that we must get a bulletin board up and running soon.

This problem may not be as significant as it appears -- but if so, we will have just added some insurance that assures our success.

Regarding the dinner, if you thought it was a good idea I would like to invite down Laurence Rockefeller and his wife to join us that evening. If he would be willing to do so it would communicate important things to Jim that should attend this discussion. You should call him from your hotel in Las Vegas (or a pay phone in Asheville) and talk to him directly (not Diamond.) The dinner party will be Sue and Jim Woolsey, Emily and you, Diane and me, and one other couple.

Keep up the good work
JL